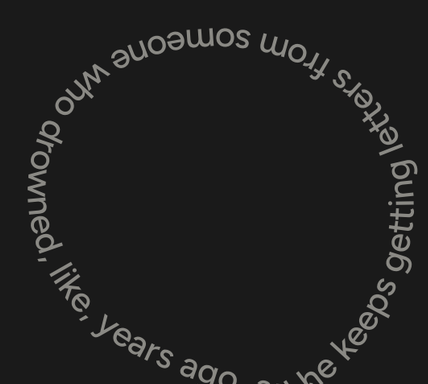
Flow

MANASI GHUTUKADE · OCTOBER 2026

FEATURE PROPOSAL · WORKING PROTOTYPE

Author *mode*

For anyone who has a book in them but thought writing one meant sitting down to write. Your thoughts, pieced together, already are one.



um, there's this lighthouse keeper, right, and he just... never opens the first one



The keeper never opened the first letter. He read it every

Writing a book shouldn’t require *writing*.

We picture writing a book as a physical act: a desk, a keyboard, a blank page, months of typing. So most people who have a book in them never start. They don’t think of themselves as writers.

But a book is really just thoughts, put in order. Everyone has thoughts, and most of us say them out loud every day, to friends, in voice notes, on long walks. The hard part was never having them. It was the typing.

> Flow already captures how people think out loud. I wanted it to help them piece those thoughts together, until one day they look back and realise they’ve written *a book*.

A whole book went through Flow. Most of the work still happened outside it.

Wispr's CEO shared that Robert Greene wrote his new book without typing a word. After a stroke in 2018 left him unable to use his right side, he wrote by hand across about a hundred notebooks, then used Flow to turn them into a manuscript. His loop:

1

Dictate

Read each handwritten page aloud into Flow.

IN FLOW

2

Print

Print the transcript to see it as a whole.

OUTSIDE

3

Mark up

Edit the printout by hand.

OUTSIDE

4

Dictate edits

Speak the changes back in, with nothing to anchor them to.

HALF IN FLOW

5

Fix the file

Clean up the document with one working hand.

OUTSIDE

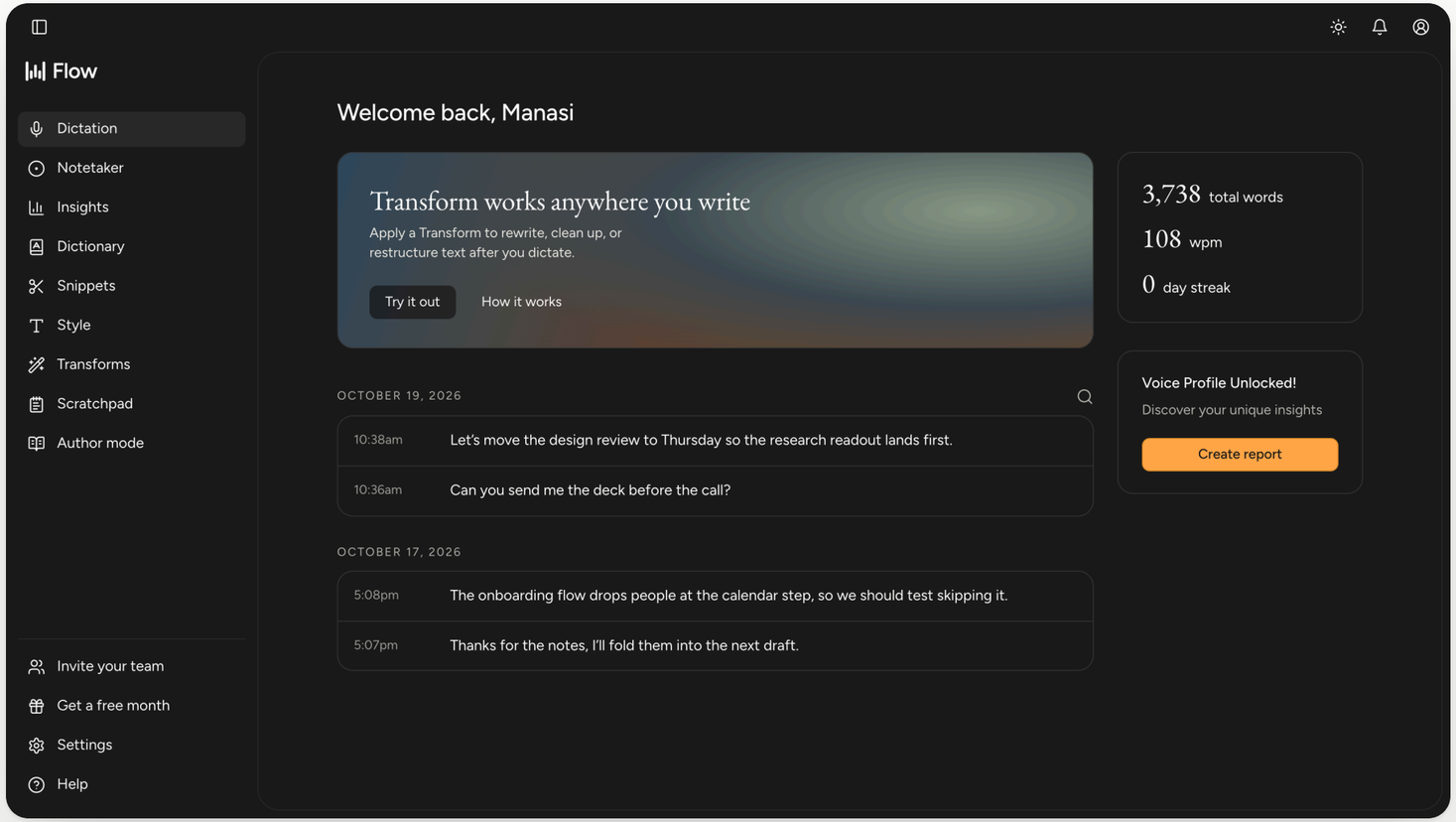
> He called it excruciating and exciting at once. If someone that practised had to fight the physical act of writing, how many people never start because of it?

03 · WHO IT'S FOR

You don't have to call yourself an *author*.

- **A grandparent** with sixty years of stories nobody has written down.
- **A founder or teacher** who explains things better out loud than on paper.
- **Anyone who can't type,** or can't for long: stroke, RSI, low vision, dyslexia.
- **Someone with a few vague ideas** and no idea where a book would even begin.

Flow already hears these thoughts. Today they land in a feed, grouped by date, and scroll away.



FLOW TODAY · THOUGHTS IN A FEED, NOT A BOOK

Nobody starts with Chapter 1.

Before designing anything, I looked at how writers work. Two camps come up again and again, and most people sit somewhere between them:

Plotters

Outline first: premise, characters, major turns. They want somewhere to keep notes before drafting.

Discovery writers

Write to find out what the story is. Structure shows up in the draft, not before it.

Scrivener's lesson

The tool long-form writers love lets you write loose scenes and gather them into chapters later.

So Author mode doesn't ask for chapters up front. It follows the order books are really made in:

Spark — vague ideas in Scratchpad → **Gather** — notes for one book → **Draft** — loose, untitled sections → **Shape** — name a section, it's a chapter → **Read** — preview as pages

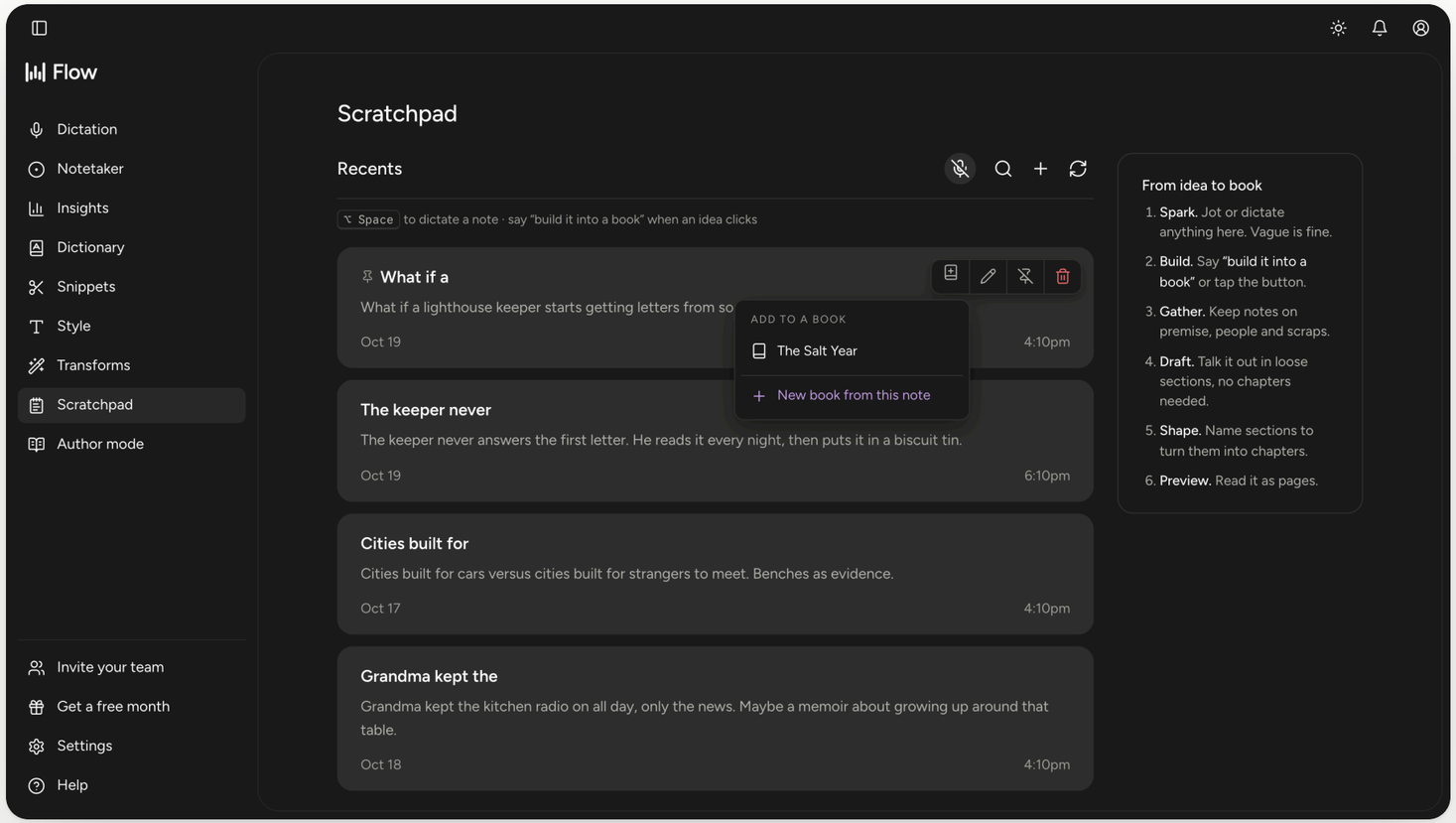
1 SPARK

Ideas start in Scratchpad, where they already live.

No new place to learn. Rough thoughts are dictated or typed into Flow's existing Scratchpad, in the same cards and the same hover toolbar.

One new icon joins edit, pin and delete. It opens a small menu: **add this note to a book you've started**, or **start a new book from it**.

Or say it: `build it into a book`



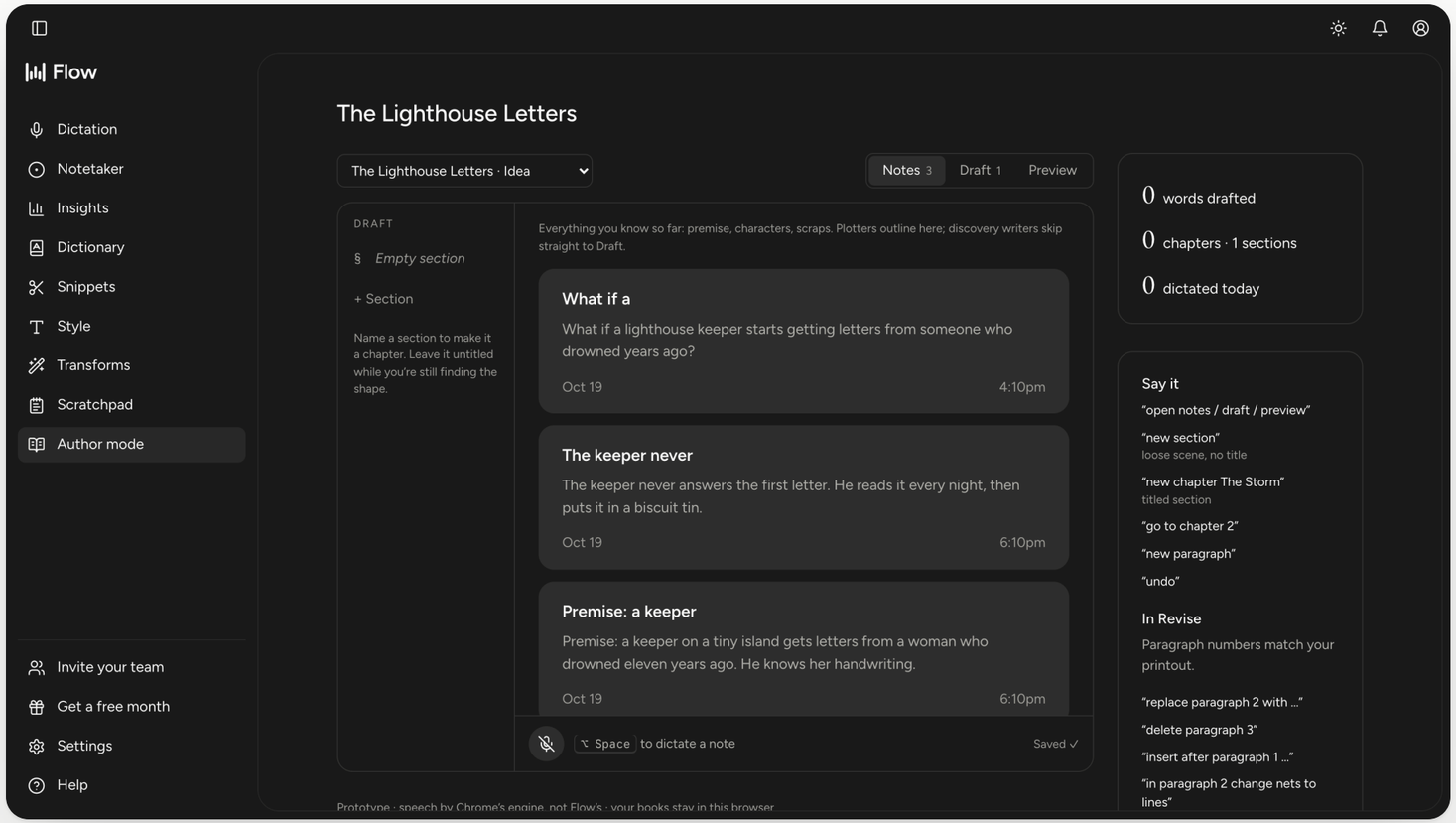
SCRATCHPAD · THE BOOK MENU ON A NOTE

2 GATHER

Starting a book doesn’t pull you away.

You stay in Scratchpad. A toast confirms it with an **Open** button, and the note gets a small tag showing which book it belongs to. More notes can join the same book later.

Inside the book, **Notes** is the first tab: premise, characters, scraps. Plotters outline here. Discovery writers skip straight to Draft.



AUTHOR MODE · A NEW BOOK’S NOTES TAB

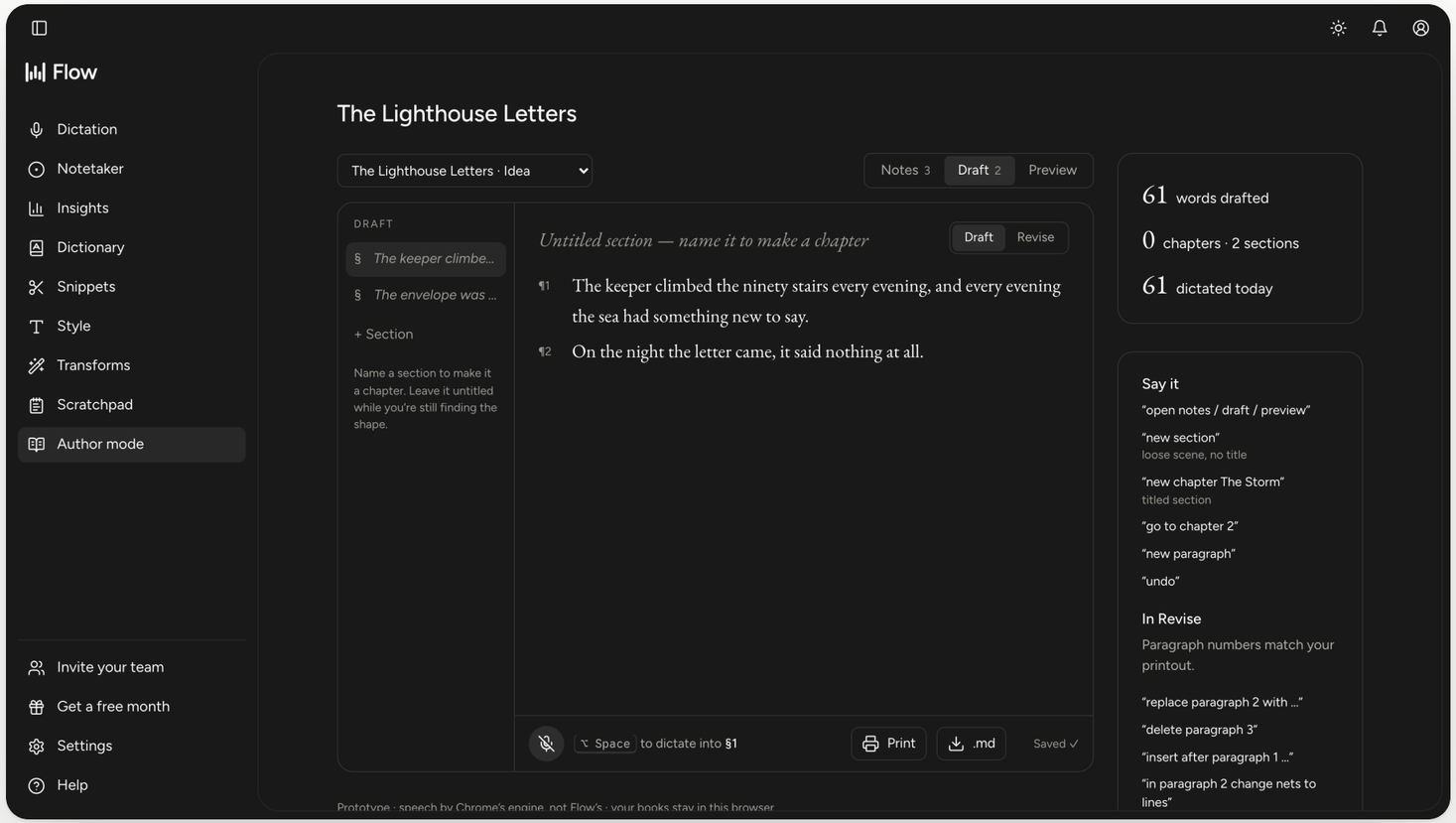
3 DRAFT

Talk the draft into existence. *No chapters required.*

The draft is a list of loose sections. Untitled sections show their first words, so you can find them without naming them.

The footer always says where your voice is going (**“Dictating into §1”**), so nothing lands in the wrong place. The mic is a toggle, not a hold, so it works one-handed or hands-free.

`new section` `new paragraph` `go to section 2`



DRAFT · LOOSE SECTIONS, NOT CHAPTERS

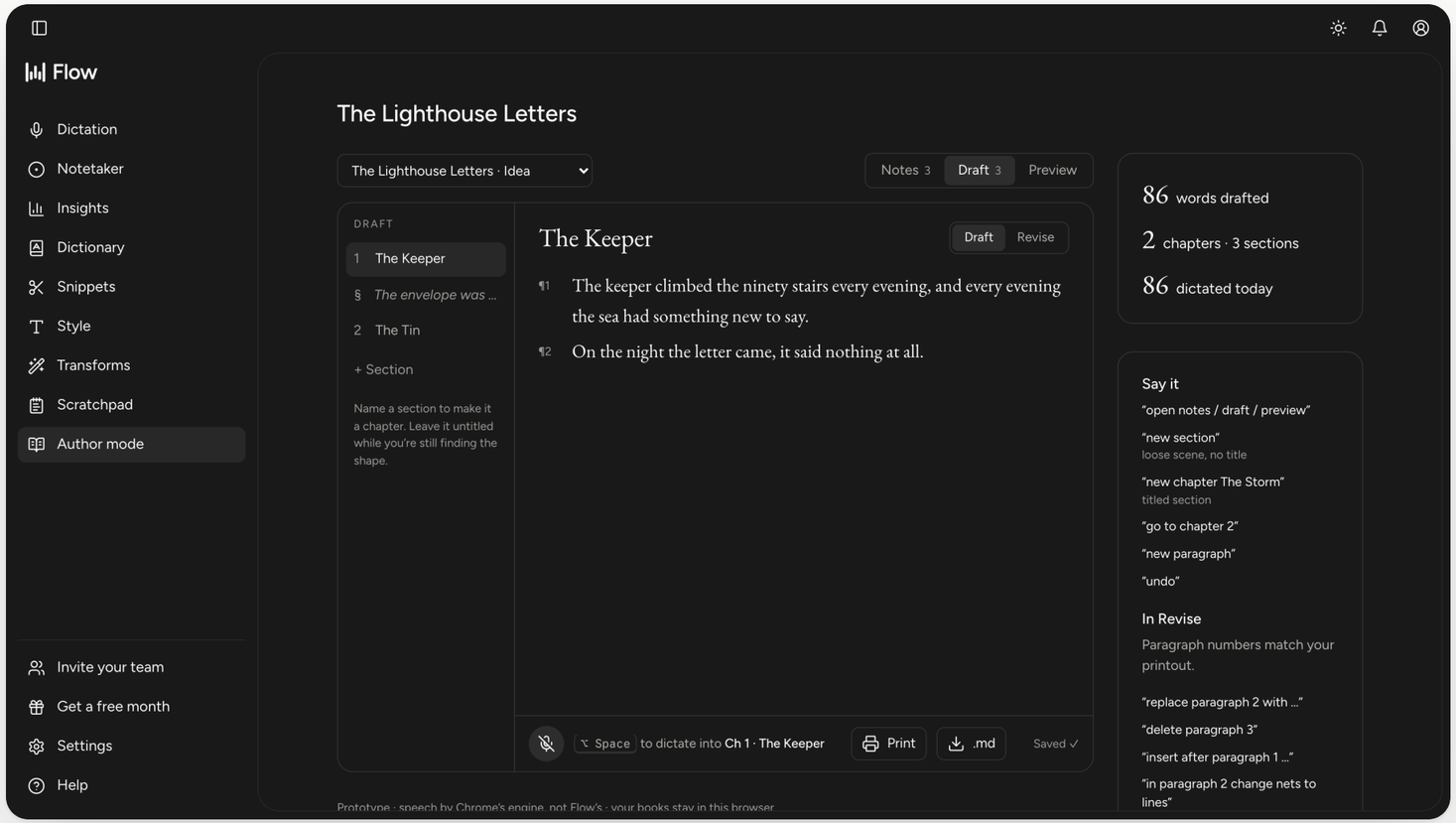
4 SHAPE

When the shape shows up, name it.

Give a section a title and it becomes a chapter, numbered automatically. Untitled sections stay as scene breaks inside the chapter before them.

Structure is something you discover and then confirm. It isn't a form you fill in on day one.

`new chapter The Tin` `go to chapter 1`



DRAFT · TWO NAMED CHAPTERS, ONE SCENE STILL UNTITLED

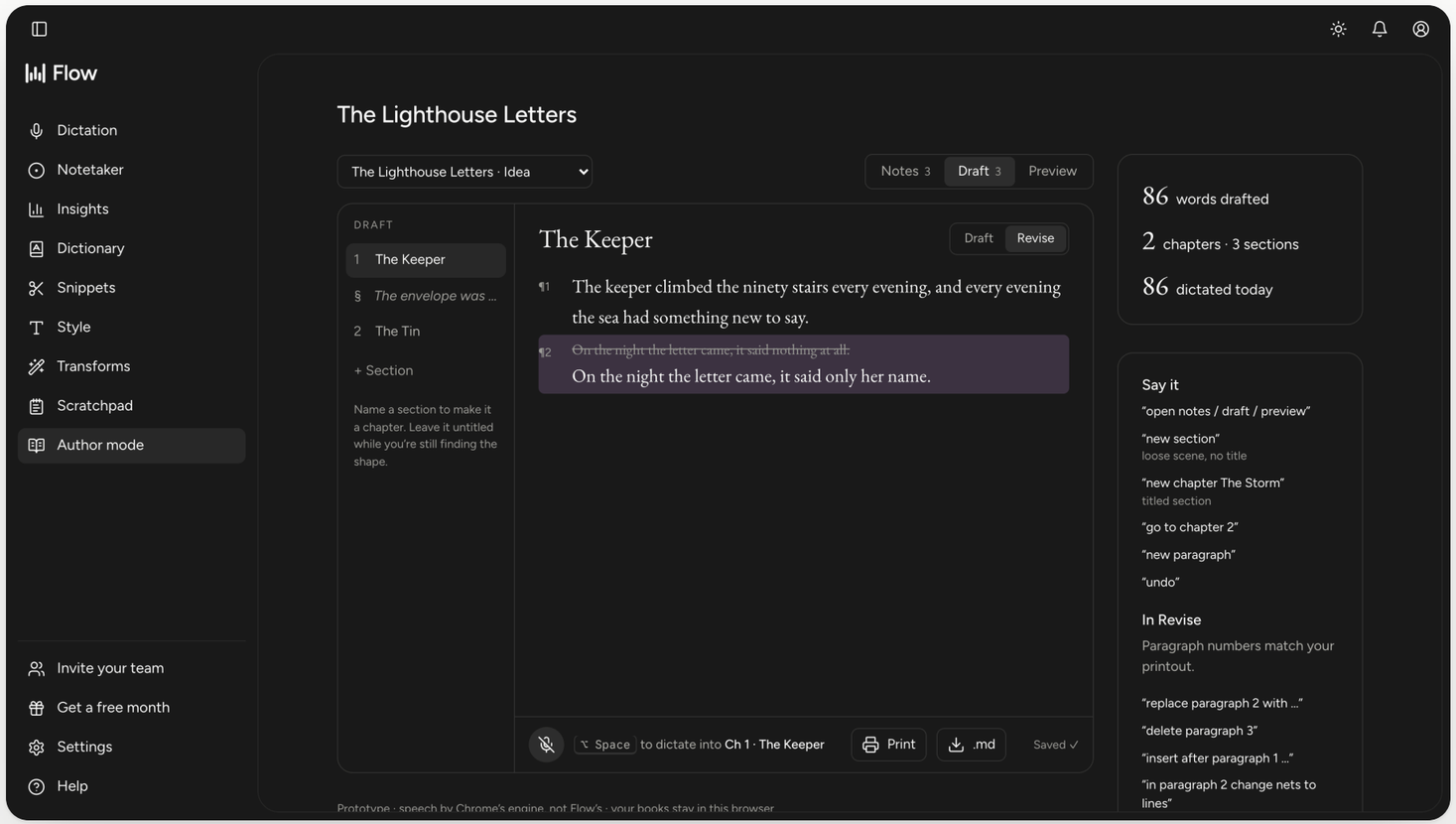
5 REVISE

Edit by paragraph number, by voice.

This closes step 4 of Greene's loop. Every paragraph is numbered, on screen and on the printout. In Revise mode you can speak an edit against a number. The paragraph flashes and shows the old text struck through, and `undo` brings it back.

`replace paragraph 2 with …`	rewrite it
`in paragraph 2 change X to Y`	swap a phrase
`insert after paragraph 1 …`	add a beat
`delete paragraph 3`	cut it

Edit commands only run in Revise, so prose that happens to start with "replace…" is never mistaken for a command while drafting.



REVISE · "IN PARAGRAPH 2 CHANGE NOTHING AT ALL TO ONLY HER NAME"

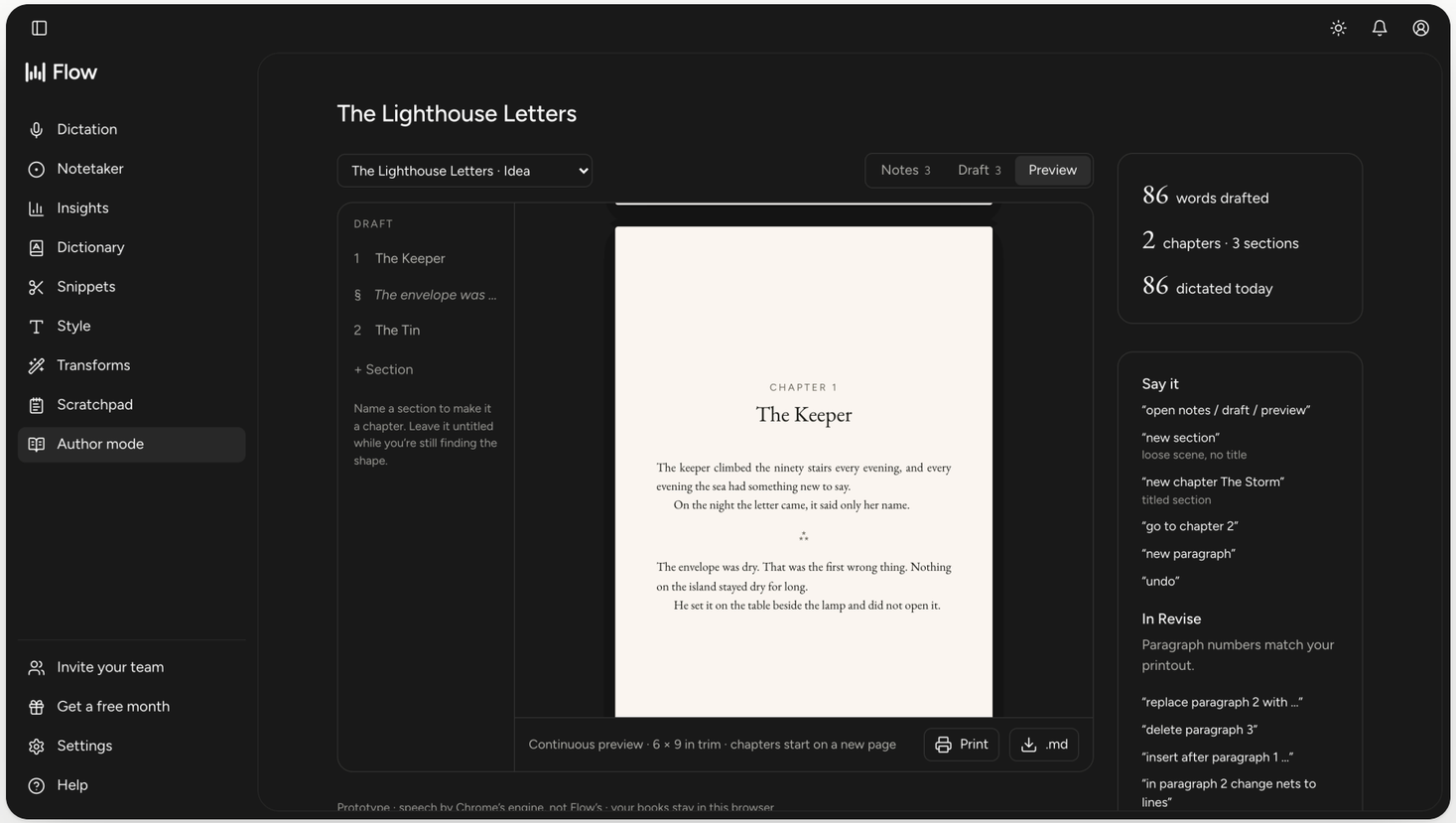
6 READ

Then read it *like a book*.

Preview lays the manuscript out as 6 × 9 pages in one continuous scroll: a title page, each chapter starting on a new page, and a ⁂ between scenes.

Seeing it as pages is what Greene printed for. The same layout prints, with ¶ numbers in the margin that match Revise, and exports to Markdown.

`show preview` `open draft`



PREVIEW · CONTINUOUS PAGES

05 · DECISIONS, AND WHY

Small on purpose.

Built on Scratchpad, not beside it

Ideas already land there. Author mode picks them up instead of asking people to move their thinking somewhere new.

Its own place in the sidebar

A book is somewhere you return to for months, so it gets a home next to Scratchpad rather than a toggle hidden on another page.

Building a book doesn’t redirect you

Ideas come in bursts. Staying in Scratchpad keeps the burst going; “Open” is one click when you’re ready.

Sections before chapters

Matches how plotters and discovery writers both actually work. Naming a section is the only step needed to make a chapter.

Voice for everything, including navigation

Every action has a spoken form, and the mic is a toggle. Someone with one working hand, or none, can write the whole book.

Paragraph numbers that match paper

The printout and the screen share one numbering, so handwritten margin notes turn directly into spoken edits.

06 · WHERE IT STANDS

A working prototype, built to Flow's look.

It runs in the browser using Flow's own fonts and colours and Chrome's speech engine.
It's a proof of the flow, not of Flow's transcription quality.

Works today

Scratchpad → book by menu or by voice

Notes, Draft, Preview per book

12 voice commands for navigation and editing

One-step undo, autosave, print and .md export

Left out on purpose

Real Flow integration and system-wide hotkey

AI rewriting (Transforms already cover it)

Sync, accounts and collaboration

.docx export and version history

Next, if this lands

Use Flow's transcription for punctuation and cleanup

Reorder sections by voice ("move section 3 after 1")

Import a stack of photographed notebook pages

Test with people who've never written anything, and with authors who dictate for accessibility